

Daily Bible Note

Date: June 21, 2026

I. Today's Reading

NKJV: Jonah 1:11-16

11 Then they said to him, "What shall we do to you that the sea may be calm for us?"—for the sea was growing more tempestuous.

12 And he said to them, "Pick me up and throw me into the sea; then the sea will become calm for you. For I know that this great tempest is because of me."

13 Nevertheless the men rowed hard to return to land, but they could not, for the sea continued to grow more tempestuous against them.

14 Therefore they cried out to the Lord and said, "We pray, O Lord, please do not let us perish for this man's life, and do not charge us with innocent blood; for You, O Lord, have done as it pleased You."

15 So they picked up Jonah and threw him into the sea, and the sea ceased from its raging.

16 Then the men feared the Lord exceedingly, and offered a sacrifice to the Lord and took vows.

II. Key Summary

- Jonah acknowledges that the storm is his fault for fleeing God's calling and tells the sailors to throw him overboard
 - The sailors exhaust every effort to row to shore and pray to the Lord before acting, unwilling to harm an innocent man
 - When Jonah is thrown into the sea, the storm immediately calms, and the sailors come to fear the Lord greatly, offering sacrifices and making vows
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III. Passage Analysis

One Person's Choice Pulls Everyone Around Them Into the Storm

"He knew he was the cause of the imminent danger threatening destruction to many others — making his willingness to sacrifice himself not merely a duty but a moral necessity." [1]

When we make wrong choices, the cost often spreads beyond us to the people nearby. Jonah's decision to face the truth and say "throw me in" took real courage — and that honesty became the turning point that changed everything.

The Last People You'd Expect Were the First to Meet God

"The sailors' progression from fearing the storm to fearing the Lord, and their vows made after being delivered, demonstrates that true faith in God comes through witnessing His power and mercy, not merely through human effort." [2]

These pagan sailors each had their own gods, yet after seeing what God actually did in that storm, they became the first ones to worship Him. Sometimes the people we'd least expect are the first to recognize the real thing when they see it.

IV. Reflection Question

Have you ever known something was your fault but kept putting it off, making excuses not to deal with it — and watched the people around you get caught in the mess too?

Jonah shows us that being honest about what we've done wrong is what opens the door — and sometimes that honesty changes not just your own situation, but the people standing right next to you.

References

[1] BibleHub.com, Benson Commentary,
<https://www.biblehub.com/commentaries/jonah/1-11.htm>

[2] Enduring Word, David Guzik Commentary on Jonah 1,
<https://enduringword.com/bible-commentary/jonah-1/>